

President Patil for standards

Closer home, opening the ISO consumer plenary meeting, the president stressed on standards on products for building confidence in the market and putting an end to the recession

Fight the SMS spam

The Indian Consumer protection act allows you to complain against the service provider if you get unsolicited messages

Consumer protection

Another reader who experienced repeated problems was Dr. Sanjay Tharoor, and he has also told me that at least for now, HP has fixed the problems with his laptop and it is working normally. HP considers that the problems have finally been resolved. Another reader with overheating problems with his Pavilion dv2701TX was Sumir Josan. HP tells me that his heatsink has been replaced, and that the laptop has been returned. We have not yet heard from Sumir.

However, some readers have told us that HP service engineers had told them that overheating is inevitable with these system, and one reader had been informed that there was an HP advisory on his model and that it was not suitable for sale in India. The advisory certainly exists - see the box for the details - but it does not suggest that the models are unsuitable for this country. But are they?

By chance, a colleague in our office has an HP Compaq Presario CQ50-106AU. When used in his home - not air-conditioned - even

Write in

If you have a genuine example of truly bad service, such as a product going wrong within warranty and the supplier refusing to fix or replace it, then please let us know at servicewatch@thinkdigit.com. Make sure that you have proper documentation (receipt, etc.) to back up your complaint. We cannot promise even to reply to all the emails we will receive, but we will pick a selection and take them up with the relevant companies at the highest level.

uses it in a normal atmosphere; like, when, you know the temperatures in Delhi; OK, obviously you will tend to see temperatures like we have [here]; we can't avoid it. Even I find a difference when I use my notebook. In the office I don't feel any issue."

Perhaps these notebooks are not suitable for sale in India - at least, not suitable for use in India during the summer without air-conditioning! It is certainly the case that a hot and humid climate is not good for computer hardware, but surely, does it make sense to sell laptops with the same thermal



In the May and June issues of Digit, we reported a large number of complaints to Hewlett-Packard. This month, HP responded with their side of the story and have also replaced several readers' laptops.

characteristics in India as in, say, Europe? Is that what HP is doing?

NVIDIA in the US has told me that the configurations of laptops are very similar among different vendors, and each particular chassis has well defined and understood thermal characteristics. It

designs its chips to match the specified thermal characteristics in order to avoid overheating. The company had not heard of problems such as our readers have been reporting, and is going to look into this further and help us understand just what might be going on here. 

Register your complaints on HP's web site at:

h20526.www2.hp.com/cchs/forms/submitcase_eu.asp?CaseType=Complaint&country=in#

Alternatively, send an email to: in.ced@hp.com or telephone: 080-2504 1020.

when running idle, it simply shuts down after about 15 minutes, apparently due to overheating. So, it was brought into our office, and placed in a properly air-conditioned room. It happily spent a couple of hours running a video - a compute-intensive application that would be likely to cause overheating, if anything would. A sample of one is not sufficient to draw conclusions, but what does HP say about this kind of experience?

Diptesh Ghosh, HP Category Manager for notebooks, talked to me of one of our readers who had been running a fairly CPU-intensive application. He said: "The issue here is when he

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